Dishwasher



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Dishwasher

What it is used for

A dishwasher cleans dishes, utensils, and food-service equipment using controlled washing, rinsing, and, where fitted, sanitising cycles. Correct loading, detergent selection, and maintenance help achieve hygienic results while protecting dishes and the machine.

Main parts

- Wash chamber and racks
- Spray arms or wash jets
- Water inlet, filters, and drain system
- Detergent and rinse-aid dispensers
- Heating element and temperature controls
- Control panel, door latch, and safety interlocks

Before you start

1. Confirm that the dishwasher is intended for the type and quantity of items being washed.
2. Check that the chamber, racks, spray arms, filters, and drain area are clean and correctly fitted.
3. Verify that water supply, drainage, power connection, and door seal are in good condition.
4. Use the detergent and rinse aid recommended for the machine and follow the product instructions.
5. Scrape large food scraps from dishes and separate items according to material and washing requirements.
6. Check that items are dishwasher-safe and that sharp knives or fragile glassware are positioned securely.

How to use

1. Switch on the dishwasher and select the appropriate wash programme for the load and soil level.
2. Load dishes into the correct racks without overcrowding or blocking spray arms.
3. Place cups, bowls, and containers so water can drain and reach all required surfaces.
4. Add the specified detergent and rinse aid to their designated compartments.
5. Close the door securely and confirm that no item prevents the door from latching.
6. Start the selected cycle and allow it to complete without opening the door unnecessarily.
7. Observe any warning indicators and stop the machine if a leak, electrical fault, or unusual noise occurs.
8. When the cycle finishes, wait for hot items and steam to settle before opening the door carefully.

9. Unload clean items with clean hands, handling them by appropriate surfaces to avoid recontamination.
10. Inspect items for remaining food, detergent residue, or water deposits; rewash items that are not clean.
11. Remove and clean the filter as instructed, then check the drain area for trapped debris.
12. Switch off the machine when required and leave it in the recommended condition for ventilation and drying.

⚠ Safety

- Follow the manufacturer's instructions and use only detergents suitable for the machine.
- Do not touch heating elements or handle hot dishes carelessly after a cycle.
- Keep electrical connections and controls dry; never operate the machine with damaged wiring or plugs.
- Do not bypass the door latch or safety interlocks.
- Switch off and isolate power before servicing or accessing electrical components.
- Use care when handling detergent and rinse aid; avoid contact with eyes and skin and follow the product label.
- Do not mix cleaning chemicals unless the product instructions explicitly permit it.

Care & storage

- Clean the filters, spray arms, door seal, and chamber at the recommended frequency.
- Check inlet hoses, drain hoses, and connections for leaks or blockage.
- Remove scale using a suitable descaling product when required by water conditions and manufacturer guidance.
- Keep detergent dispensers and rinse-aid compartments clean and correctly filled.
- Arrange servicing if washing performance declines, heating fails, or drainage becomes unreliable.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Overloading racks or blocking spray arms with dishes.
- Using unsuitable detergent or excessive detergent quantity.
- Ignoring clogged filters or blocked drainage.
- Opening the machine carelessly while hot steam or water may escape.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar